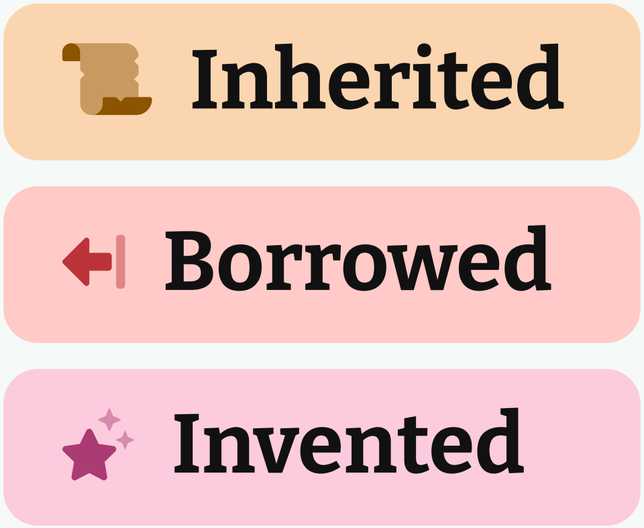
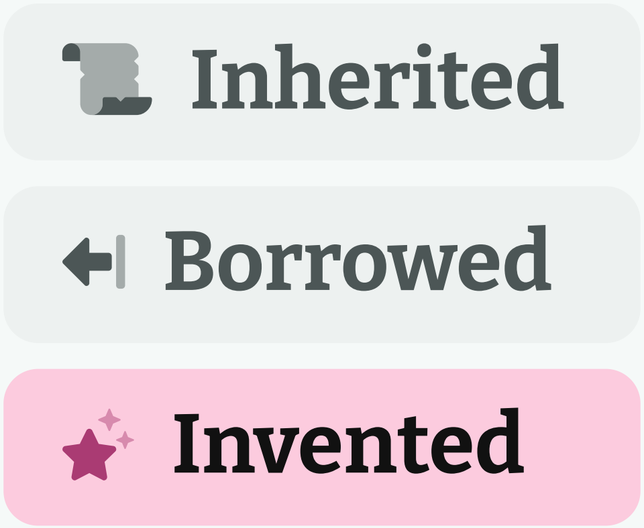
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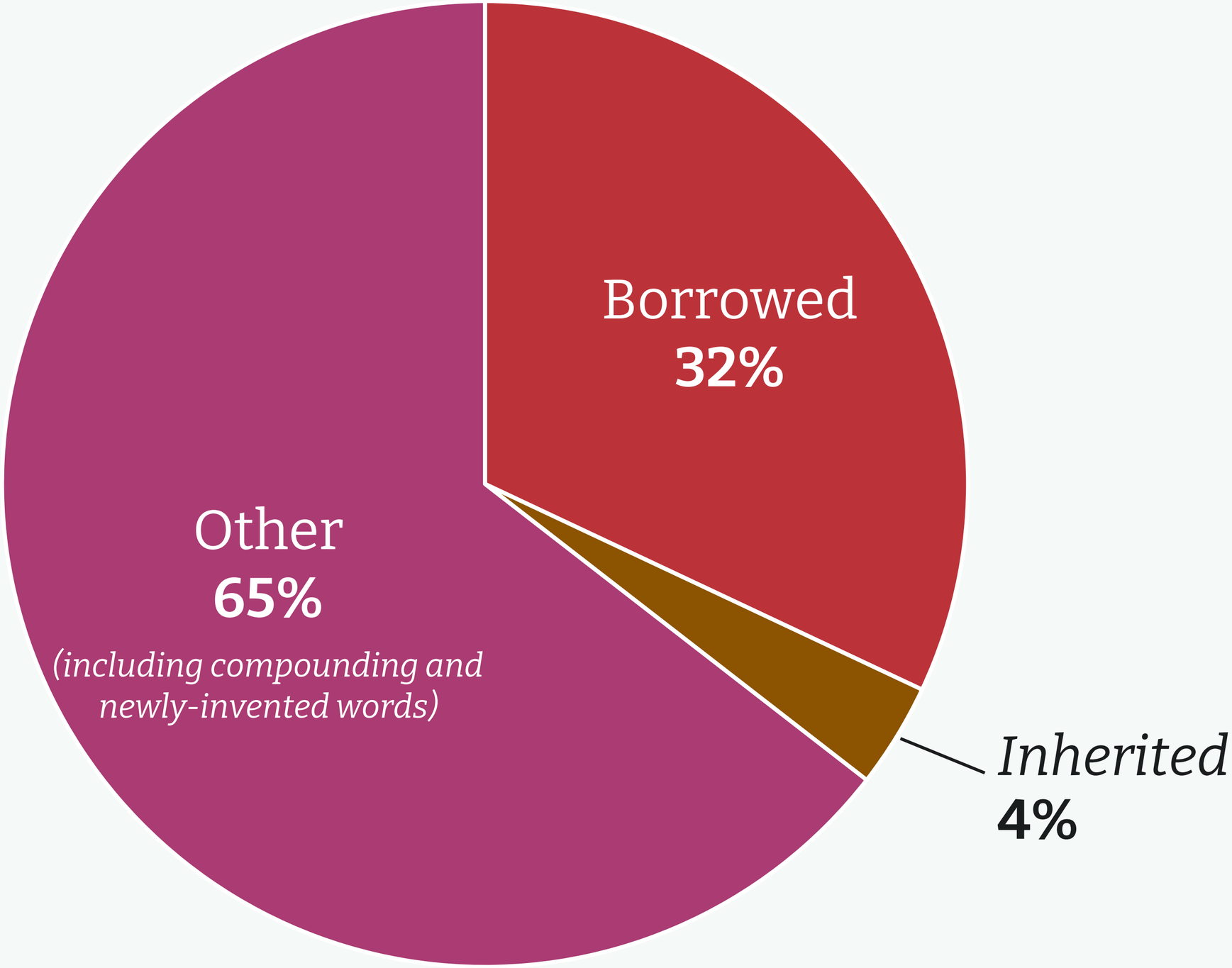
Neologisms: New and Improved

Marc Alexander

English Language & Linguistics 2A, Week 5


Inherited
Borrowed
Invented


Inherited
Borrowed
Invented


Borrowed
32%
Other
65%
(including compounding and
newly-invented words)
Inherited
4%

not a real word

a ‘made-up’ word

ish, like. ad. *beastly, beastlike; piteously, pitifully.*

LYCANTHROPY. *n. s.* [*lycanthropie*, Fr. *λυκος* and *ανθρ.*] A kind of madness, in which men have the qualities of wild beasts.

He sees like a man in his sleep, and grows as much the worse as the man that dreamt of a goose-cap, and was the ever after wary not to come near a pond. *Taylor.*

LYNX. *adj.* for *like.* *Spenser.*

LYING. *participial noun*, from *lie*, whether it signifies *to be recumbent*, or *to speak falsely*.

Thou will have me whipt for speaking true, thou will have me whipt for lying, and sometimes I am whipt for holding my peace. *Shakspeare's King Lear.*

Many times and intimations betid me by the lying in wait of the Jews. *Wotton.*

LYMPH. *n. s.* [*lympha*, Fr. *lympha*, Lat.] Water; transparent colourless liquor.

When the chyle passeth through the mesentery, it is mixed with the lymph, the most spirituous and elaborated part of the blood. *Arbuthnot on Aliments.*

LYMPHATED. *adj.* [*lymphatus*, Lat.] Mad. *Dict.*

LYMPHATICK. *n. s.* [*lymphatique*, Fr. from *lympha*, Lat.]

The lymphaticks are slender pellucid tubes, whose coats are contracted at small and unequal distances, and therefore they are corded and moniliform: they carried from the glands of the mesentery, to the thoracick duct, which discharges the chyle and lymph into the left subclavian vein. *Cheyne's Philosophical Principles.*

Upon the death of an animal, the spirits retire into the veins, or lymphaticks, and glandules. *Grew.*

LYMPHEDUCT. *n. s.* [*lympha* and *ductus*, Latin.] A vessel which conveys the lymph.

The glands,
All nothil knots, of various hollow threads,
Which lymphaducts, an nut'ry, nerves, and veins,
Invade'n and close together wounds, contain. *Blackmore.*

LYNDEN TREE. *n. s.* [*tilia*, Lat.] A plant.

LYNX. *n. s.* [Lat.] A spotted beast, remarkable for speed and sharp sight.

We that have no bliss of a beast with specs, less but a slender distinguished from a lynx.

What shadow of slight betwixt each wide extreme,
The mole's dim curtain, and the lynx's beam. *Pope.*

LYRE. *n. s.* [*lyre*, Fr. *lyra*, Lat.] A musical instrument to which poetry is, by poetical writers, supposed to be sung.

With other notes than to th' Orphean lyre. *Milton.*

LYR

LYRICAL. *adj.* [*lyricus*, Lat.]

LYRICK. *n. s.* [*lyricus*, Lat.]

LYRIST. *n. s.* [*lyriste*, Lat.]

M.

MAC

MAS, in English, one unvaried sound, by compression of the lips: as, *mine, time, lame, comp*: it is never mute.

MACARO'ON. *n. s.* [*macaronee*, Ital.]

1. A coarse, rude, low fellow; whence *macaronick* poetry, in which the language is purposely corrupted.

Like a big wife, at night of lothed meat,
Ready to travail: so I sigh and sweat,
To bear this monstrous talk on in vain. *Donne.*

2. [*Macaron*, Fr.] A kind of sweet biscuit, made of flour, almonds, eggs, and sugar.

MACA'W. *n. s.* A bird in the West Indies; the largest species of parrot.

MACA'W-TREE. *n. s.*

A species of the palm-tree, very common in the Carribbee islands, where the ingrown pieces the tender fruit, whence issues a pleasant liquor: and the body of the tree affords a solid timber, supposed by some to be a sort of ebony. *Miller.*

MACE. [*maza*, Sax. *maca*, Span.]

1. An ensign of authority borne before magistrates.

He mightily upheld that royal mace
Which now thou bear'st. *Fairy Queen.*

2. [*Masse*, Fr. *mazza*, Lat.] A heavy blunt weapon; a club of metal.

O mortal sin! this slumber!
Lay'st thou thy leaden mace upon my boy
That slays thy morals? *Shakspeare's Julius Cæsar.*

The Turkish troops breaking in with their scymitars and heavy iron maces, made a most bloody execution. *Knolles.*

Death with his mace petrifick smote. *Milton.*

With his mace their monarch struck the ground;
With forward trembling earth receiv'd the wound.
And rising streams a ready passage found. *Dryden.*

The mighty maces with such haste descend,
They break the bones, and make the armour bend. *Dryden.*

3. [*Macis*, Lat.] A kind of spice.

The nutmeg is inclosed in a threefold covering, of which the second is mace; it is thin and membranaceous, of an oleaginous and a yellowish colour: it has an extremely fragrant, aromatick, and agreeable smell, and a pleasant, but acrid and oleaginous taste. *Hill's Materia Medica.*

Water, vinegar, and honey, to a mean excellent sorbitick; it is the more effectual with a little mace added to it. *Arbuthnot.*

MACA'LE. *n. s.* [*mace* and *ale*.] Ale spiced with mace.

I prescribed him a draught of macrale, with hopes to dispose him to rest. *Warmer's Surgery.*

MA'CEBEARER. *n. s.* [*mace* and *bear*.] One who carries the mace before persons in authority.

I was placed at a quadrangular table, opposite to the macebearer. *Addison.*

To MA'CERATE. *v. a.* [*macero*, Lat. *macerer*, Fr.]

1. To make lean; to waste away.

Recrement gains of the stomach, sanguine, and other recrement bread-urines, macerate the parts, and render the lanks of patients consumptive and pining. *Harvey on Consumptions.*

2. To mortify; to harass with corporal hardships.

Convents men are all fools: for what greater folly can there be, or madness, than for such a man to macerate himself when he need not. *Burton on Melan.*

One of an excess of zeal they practise mortifications; they macerate their bodies, and impair their health. *Hakew.*

3. To steep almost to solution.

In lotions in women's cases, he orders two portions of hellebore macerated in two ozeyes of water. *Arb.*

MACERA'TION. *n. s.* [*maceration*, Fr. from *macerate*.]

1. The act of wasting or making lean.

2. Mortification; corporal hardship.

3. *Maceration* is an infusion either with or without heat, wherein the ingredients are intended to be almost wholly dissolved.

The saliva serves for a maceration and dissolution of the meat into a chyle. *Ray on the Creation.*

MACE-REED. *n. s.* [*typha*.] An herb. *Quincy.*

MA'CHINAL. *adj.* [from *machina*, Lat.] Relating to machines. *Dict.*

To MA'CHINATE. *v. a.* [*machinor*, Lat. *machiner*, Fr.] To plan; to contrive.

MACHINA'TION. *n. s.* [*machinatio*, Lat. *machination*, Fr. from *machinate*.] Artifice; contrivance; malicious scheme.

If you miscarry,
Your business of the world hath so an end,
And machination ceases. *Shakspeare's King Lear.*

O from their machinations free,
That would my guilty soul betray;
From those who in my wrongs agree,
And for my life their engines lay. *Sandys.*

Be frustrate all ye stratagems of hell,
And devilish machinations come to nought. *Milton.*

How were they zealous in respect to their temporal governours? Not by open rebellion, not by private machinations; but in blessing and submitting to their emperors, and obeying them in all things but their idolatry. *Sprat.*

MACHI'NE. *n. s.* [*machina*, Lat. *machine*, Fr. This word is pronounced *masheen*.]

1. Any complicated work in which one part contributes to the motion of another.

We are led to conceive this great *machine* of the world to have been once in a state of greater simplicity, as to conceive a watch to have been once in its first materials. *Burnet.*

In a watch's fine machine,
The added movements which declare
How full the moon, how old the year,
Deceive their secondary pow'r
From that which simply points the hour. *Prior*

2. An engine.

In the hollow side,
Selected members of their soldiers hide;
With lowered wrest the fierce machine they load,
And iron bowels stuff the dark abode. *Dryden.*

3. Supernatural agency in poems.

The marvellous table includes whatever is supernatural, and especially the machines of the gods. *Pope.*

MACHI'NERY. *n. s.* [from *machine*.]

1. Enginery; complicated workmanship; self-moved engines.

2. The *machinery* signifies that part which the deities, angels, or demons, act in a poem. *Pope.*

MA'CHINIST. *n. s.* [*machinista*, Fr. from *machina*, Lat.] A constructor of engines or machines.

MA'CILENCY. *n. s.* [from *macilent*.] Leanness. *Dict.*

MA'CILENT. *adj.* [*macilentus*, Lat.] Lean.

MA'CKEREL. *n. s.* [*mackereel*, Dut. *maquereau*, Fr.] A sea-fish.

Some fish are gutted, split, and kept in pickle; as whiting and mackerel. *Carew's Survey of Cornwall.*

Law ordered that the Sunday should have rest;

MAD

And that no rough law order'd should disturb it,
Except it were new fish or mackerel. *Carew.*

Summer shall next invite fresh sports,
And restored mackerel gluts the greedy coasts. *Dryden.*

MACKEREL-GALE. *n. s.* A strong breeze.

MACRE'ANT. *adj.* [*macreant*, Fr. from *macer* and *croire*.] The whole world, or visible system, in opposition to the microcosm, or world of man.

MACTA'TION. *n. s.* [*mactatus*, Lat.] The act of killing for sacrifice.

*MACULA. *n. s.* [Lat.]

1. A spot.

And lastly, the body of the sun receives one part of the year more copious exhalations than another, which spots or macular generations do manifest, and in their position do usually follow the ecliptick. *Brown's Vulgar Errours.*

2. [In physick.] Any spots upon the skin, whether those in fevers or scorbutick habits.

To MA'CULATE. *v. a.* [*macula*, Lat.] To stain; to spot.

MACULA'TION. *n. s.* [from *maculate*.]

1. Spot; taint.

I will throw my glove to death himself,
That there's no maculation in it. *Shakspeare.*

MA'CULE. *n. s.* [*macula*, Lat.] A spot; a stain.

MAD. *adj.* [*gemad*, Sax. *mad*, Dut.]

1. Disordered in the mind; broken in the understanding; disturbed; senseless without a fever.

Mark, sir, he is mad.
'Tis the Moor's plague when madness has no fever. *Otway.*

This world's mad too, let it mend its own.
For though it have help'd madness to the full,
In me, it swears, it will make wise amends. *Ben Jonson.*

Cupid, of those the poets sing,
The mother bore the son was raving;
But their story must be mended,
We must bind our parents in chains, for fear
Lest they break their locks and bars, and so set
Mischief free from. *Taylor's Holy Dying.*

A bear, enraged at the stinging of a bee, in a mad fit into the bee-garden, and overset all the hives. *L'Estrange.*

Madness ought not to be mad,
But who can help his frenzy? *Dryden's Spanish Friar.*

But some revenge grows out of things mad,
We just our ends, and we just are mad. *Dryden.*

2. Expressing disorder of mind.

His gestures fierce
He mark'd, and mad demeanour then alone. *Milton.*

3. Over-run with any violent or unreasonable desire: with *at*, *after*, or *to*: as, *to have better fire, before the stove is mad at fire.*

It is the land of green ginger, and has an eye across their land. *Howell.*

The world is raving and after love, in pursuit of bad pastors, or rather the judgment for the vigour domestick nothing.

The people are not so mad and of wars, for as they could be content to be the friend of peace. *Dryden.*

4. Enraged; furious.

Wide with impression St. Paul is making forward the church, and persecuting the way to death, and being exceedingly mad against them. *Acts of the*

LYING. *part. noun*, from *lie*. *Shakspeare.*

LYMPH. *n. s.* [*lympha*, Lat.] Water; transparent colourless liquor. *Arbuthnot.*

LYMPHATED. *a.* [*lymphatus*, Lat.] Mad.

LYMPHATICK. *s.* [from *lympha*, Lat.] The *lymphaticks* are slender pellucid tubes, whose cavities are contracted at small and unequal distances; they are carried into the glands of the mesentery. *Cheyne.*

LYMPHEDUCT. *s.* [*lympha* and *ductus*, Lat.] A vessel which conveys the lymph. *Blackmore.*

LYR

LYNX. *s.* [Lat.] A spotted beast, remarkable for speed and sharp sight. *Locke.*

LYRE. *s.* [*lyre*, Fr.; *lyra*, Lat.] A harp; a musical instrument to which poetry is supposed to be sung. *Prior.*

LYRICAL. *a.* [*lyricus*, Lat.] Pertaining to a harp; to a harp; singing to a harp. *Pope.*

LYRICK. *s.* A poet who writes songs to the harp. *Addison.*

LYRIST. *s.* [*lyriste*, Lat.] A musician who plays upon the harp. *Pope.*

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MACA'W. *s.* A bird in the West Indies, the largest species of parrot.

MACA'W-TREE. *s.* A species of the *palm-tree*. *Miller.*

MACE. *s.* [*maza*, Sax.; *mace*, Span.] An ensign of authority borne before magistrates. *Spenser.* [*masse*, Fr.; *massa*, Lat.] A heavy blunt weapon; a club of metal. *Knolles.* [*macis*, Lat.] A kind of spice. The nutmeg is enclosed in a threefold covering, of which the second is *mace*. *Hill.*

MACEALE. *s.* [*mace* and *ale*.] Ale spiced with mace. *Wiseman.*

MA'CEBEARER. *s.* [*mace* and *bearer*.] One who carries the mace before persons in authority. *Spectator.*

To MA'CERATE. *v. a.* [*macero*, Lat.] To make lean; to wear away. *Harvey.* To mortify; to harass with corporal hardships. *Burton.* To steep almost to solution. *Arbuthnot.*

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MA'CILENCY. *s.* [from *macilent*.] Leanness.

MA'CILENT. *a.* [*macilentus*, Lat.] Lean.

MA'CKEREL. *s.* [*mackereel*, Dutch.] A sea fish. *Gay.*

MA'CKEREL-GALE. A strong breeze. *Dryd.*

MA'CROCOSM. *s.* [*μακρος* and *κοσμος*.] The whole world, or visible system, in opposition to the microcosm, or world of man.

MACTATION. *s.* [*mactatus*, Lat.] The act of killing for sacrifice.

*MACULA. *s.* [Latin.] A spot. *Burnet.* [In physick] Any spots upon the skin, whether those in fevers or scorbutick habits.

To MA'CULATE. *v. a.* [*maculo*, Latin.] To stain; to spot.

MACULATION. *s.* [from *maculate*.] Stain; spot; taint. *Shakspeare.*

MAG

MA'CULE. *s.* [*macula*, Lat.] A spot; a stain.

MAD. *a.* [*gemad*, Saxon.] Disordered in the mind; broken in the understanding; distracted. *Taylor.* Expressing disorder of mind. *Milton.* Overrun with any violent or unreasonable desire. *Rymer.* Enraged; furious. *Decay of Piety.*

To MAD. *v. a.* To make mad; to make furious; to enrage. *Sidney.*

To MAD. *v. n.* To be mad; to be furious. *Milt.*

MAD. *s.* [*malo*, Sax.] An earthworm. *Ainsw.*

MA'DAM. *s.* [*ma dame*, French; my dame.] The term of compliment used in address to ladies of every degree. *Spenser. Pliofax.*

MA'DBRAIN. *s.* [*mad* and *brain*.] Madhead. *Shakspeare.*

MA'DBRAINED. *a.* [*mad* and *brain*.] Disordered in the mind; hotheaded. *Shakspeare.*

MA'DCAP. *s.* A madman; a wild hotbrained fellow. *Shakspeare.*

To MA'DDEN. *v. n.* [from *mad*.] To become mad; to act as mad. *Pope.*

To MA'DDEN. *v. a.* To make mad. *Thomson.*

MA'DDER. *s.* [*maberpe*, Sax.] A plant. *Hill.*

MADE. The participle preterite of *make.*

MADEFA'CTION. *s.* [*madefactio*, Lat.] The act of making wet. *Bacon.*

To MA'DEFY. *v. a.* [*madefio*, Lat.] To moisten; to make wet.

MA'DGEHOWLET. *s.* An owl. *Ainsworth.*

MA'DHOUSE. *s.* [*mad* and *house*.] A house where madmen are cured or confined. *L'Estr.*

MA'DLY. *ad.* [from *mad*.] Without understanding; furiously. *Dryden.*

MA'DMAN. *s.* [*mad* and *man*.] A man deprived of his understanding. *Sandys.*

MA'DNESS. *s.* [from *mad*.] Distraction; loss of understanding; perturbation of the faculties. *Locke.* Fury; wildness; rage. *K. Chas.*

MADRIER. *s.* A thick plank armed with iron pixtes, having a cavity sufficient to receive the mouth of the petard when charged, with which it is applied against a gate. *Bailey.*

MA'DRIGAL. *s.* [*madrigal*, Spanish and Fr.] A pastoral song. *Dryden.*

MA'DWORT. *s.* [*mad* and *wort*.] An herb.

MAERE. *ad.* It is derived from the Saxon *mep*, famous, great, noted: so *mærere* is all famous. *Gibson.*

To MA'FFLE. *v. n.* To stammer. *Ainsworth.*

MA'FFLER. *s.* A stammerer. *Ainsworth.*

MAGAZINE. *s.* [*magazine*, Fr.] A storehouse, commonly an arsenal or armoury, or repository of provisions. *Pope.* Of late this word has signified a miscellaneous pamphlet, from a periodical miscellany called the Gentleman's Magazine.

MAGE. *s.* [*magus*, Lat.] A magician. *Spenser.*

MA'GGOT. *s.* [*malle*, Sax.] A small grub which turns into a fly. *Ray.* Whimsey; capricc; odd fancy. *Arbuthnot.*

MA'GGOTTINESS. *s.* [from *maggot*.] The state of abounding with maggots.

MA'GGOTTY. *a.* [from *maggot*.] Full of maggots. Capricious; whimsical. *Norris.*

MAGICAL. *a.* [from *magick*.] Acting or performed by secret and invisible powers. *Hooke.*

MAGICALLY. *ad.* According to the rites of magick; by enchantment. *Cowley.*

MAGICK. *s.* [*magia*, Lat.] The art of putting in action the power of spirits; sorcery; enchantment. *Bacon.* The secret operations of natural powers. *Raleigh.*

MAGICAL. *a.* Enchanted; necromantick. *Sandys.* Done or produced by magick. *Milton.*

MAGICIAN. *s.* [*magicus*, Lat.] One skilled in magick; a necromancer. *Locke.*

MAGISTERIAL. *a.* [from *magister*, Latin.] Such as suits a master. *Addison.* Lofty; arrogant; proud; insolent; despotick. *South.* Chemically prepared, after the manner of a magistery. *Boyle.*

MAGISTERIALLY. *ad.* Arrogantly; with an air of authority. *South.*

MAGISTERIALNESS. *s.* [from *magisterial*.] Haughtiness; airs of a master. *Gov. of Tongue.*

MAGISTERY. *s.* [*magisterium*, Lat.] *Magistery* is a term now in use only in books of chemistry, and sometimes a very fine powder, and sometimes a very fine substance; but the most genuine acception is that preparation of any body, wherein the whole, or most part, is, by the addition of some what, changed into a body of quite another kind. *Quincy.*

MAGISTRACY. *s.* [*magistratus*, Latin.] Office or dignity of a magistrate. *B. Jonson.*

MAGISTRALLY. *ad.* [*magistralis*, low Lat.] Despotically; authoritatively; magisterially. *Shakspeare.*

MAGISTRATE. *s.* [*magistratus*, Lat.] A man publickly invested with authority; a governour. *Decay of Piety.*

MAGISTRATICAL. *s.* [*magistratus*, Latin.] A great thing; something above the common rate. *Bacon.*

MAGNANIMITY. *s.* [*magnanimité*, French; *magnanimitas*, Latin.] Greatness of mind; greatness of soul. *Spenser. Sandys.* Elevation of mind; elevated in sentiment; brave. *Grew.*

MAGNANIMOUS. *a.* [*magnanimus*, Latin.] Great of mind; elevated in sentiment; brave.

MAGNANIMOUSLY. *ad.* Bravely; with great. *Milton.*

MAGNA'NIMOUSNESS. *s.* [from *magnanimous*.] The loadstone; greatness of mind. *Milton.*

MAGNET. *s.* [*magnes*, Lat.] The loadstone; the stone that attracts iron. *Dryden.*

MAGNETICAL. *a.* [from *magnet*.] Relating to the magnet. *Newton.*

MAGNE'TICK. *a.* [from *magnet*.] Having powers correspondent to those of the magnet. *Bacon.* Attractive; having the power to draw things distant. *Donne.*

MAGNETISM. *s.* [from *magnet*.] Power of the loadstone. *Brown.* Power of attraction. *Glan.*

MAGNIFIABLE. *a.* [from *magnify*.] Worthy to be extolled or praised; unusual. *Brown.*

MAGNIFICAL. *a.* [*magnificus*, Lat.] High; great. *Milton.*

MAGNIFICK. *a.* [from *magnificus*, Lat.] Grand; splendid; pompous. *Addison.* Fond of splendour; setting great store to shew. *Newton.*

MAGNIFICENCE. *s.* [*magnificentia*, Latin.] Grandeur of appearance; splendour. *Milton.*

MAGNIFICENTLY. *ad.* [from *magnificent*.] Pompously; splendidly. *Grew.*

*MAGNIFICO. *s.* [Italian.] A grandee of Venice. *Shakspeare.*

MAGNIFIER. *s.* [from *magnify*.] One that praises; an encomiast; an extoller. *Brown.*

To MAGNIFY. *v. a.* [*magnifico*, Latin.] To make great; to exaggerate; to amplify; to extol. *Bacon.* To exalt; to elevate; to raise in estimation. *Milton.* To raise in power or profession. *Dan.* To increase the bulk of any object to the eye. *Locke.*

MAGNITUDE. *s.* [*magnitudo*, Lat.] Greatness; greatness of bulk. *Milton.* Comparative bulk. *Newton.*

MAGPIE. *s.* [from *pie* and *mag*, contracted from *Margaret*.] A bird sometimes taught to talk. *Peacham.*

MAGYDARE. *s.* [*magydaris*, Lat.] An herb. *Ainsworth.*

MAID. } *s.* [*maiden*, *meydhen*, Sax.; *meid*,
MAIDEN. } Dutch.] An unmarried woman; a virgin. *Dryden.* A woman servant. *Pope.* Fortune. *Leviticus.*






DISNEYLAND
SCHEMATIC AERIAL VIEW
APPROX. 45 ACRES
WITHIN RAILROAD TRACKS
• DESIGNED BY WED ENTERPRISES •
THE HUB
RECREATION PARK
FRONTIER COUNTRY
FANTASY LAND
MICKEY MOUSE CLUB
LILLIPUTIAN LAND
HOLIDAY LAND
WORLD OF TOMORROW
TRUE-LIFE ADVENTURELAND
MAIN STREET
PARKING
N
W
E
S


Forth
Loch Lomond
Stirling
Kirkcaldy
Loch Fyne
Hill of Stake 522 m
Glasgow
CENTRAL BELT
Pentland Hills
Clyde
Arran
Brodick
LOWLANDS


Forth
Loch Lomond
Stirling
Kirkcaldy
Loch Fyne
Hill of Stake 522 m
Glasgow
CENTRAL BELT
Pentland Hills
Clyde
Goat Fell 874 m
Arran
Brodick
LOWLANDS
Broad La 840 m


Loch Fyne
Loch Lomond
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Stirling
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LOWLANDS
Broad La 840 m

New words?

~~*goed*~~ *went*

~~*regaler*~~ *more regal*

~~*gaven't*~~ *didn't give*

~~*difficultness*~~ *difficulty*

The quality, fact, or condition of being difficult (in various senses); difficulty.

Thesaurus »

1549 E. ALLEN tr. L. Juda *Paraphr. Reuelacion S. John* f. xxix, in M. Coverdale et al. tr. Erasmus *Paraphr. Newe Test.* II Ye former chapter nexte goyng before being wel vnderstande, there is no great difficultnes nor hardnes in this.

1580 J. FRAMPTON tr. N. Monardes *Dial. Yron* in *Ioyfull Newes* (new ed.) f. 170 It toke away the difficultnesse of the swallowing downe.

1644 K. DIGBY *Two Treat.* II. viii. 414 The difficultnesse of this subiect..would not allow vs that liberty.

1684 S. PORDAGE tr. T. Willis *Pharmaceutice Rationalis: Second Pt.* in *Pract. Physick* (rev. ed.) iii. 179 Difficultness of Breathing,..frequent Swoonings, and inordinate suffusions of Heat and Cold follow.

1790 W. MARSHALL *Rural Econ. Midland Counties* II. Index sig. Gg4 Grazing cattle..evidence of its difficultness.

1854 *Q. Jrnl. Amer. Unitarian Assoc.* Apr. 213 The third test of the comparative importance of miracles is the *difficultness of accomplishment*.

1898 *Lit. Digest* 5 Nov. 564/2 Very many persons judge a problem wholly by its difficultness.

1934 'C. S. FORESTER' *Peacemaker* 19 He was experienced now in Mary's 'difficultness'.

1966 *Portsmouth (*New Hampsh.*) Herald* 9 Dec. 8/1 A new law is on the books requiring New Hampshire ski areas to designate the difficultness of their trails by color symbols.

2002 M. H. BORNSTEIN & M. E. LAMB *Devel. in Infancy* (2008) x. 365 Prediction from infant difficultness to later behaviour problems has been inconsistent.

(Hide quotations)

Information

- Using the OED
- Understanding entries
- About the OED
- Editorial policy
- Purchasing
- Institutional account management
- Get help with access
- Updates
  - Platform updates
  - September 2026
    - **New word entries**
    - New senses
    - New additions to unrevised entries
  - June 2026
  - March 2026
  - December 2025
  - September 2025
  - June 2025
  - March 2025

New word entries

- ablution block, n.
- attention economy, n.
- auto-reply, n.
- azmari, n.
- bachgen, n.
- Bahraini, n. & adj.
- bassy, adj.
- berbere, n.
- big bounce, n.
- bimpert, n.
- blue curacao, n.
- blue space, n.

- lapdogging, n.
- leewardly, adv.
- lunar eclipse, n.
- lunar tide, n.
- magic trick, n.
- memory care, n.
- milk sister, n.
- mountweazel, n.
- muchomo, n.
- nana, n.[3]
- nani, n.
- Native Hawaiian, n.
- New Zealand English, n. & adj.
- no-gi, n.
- no-platform, v.
- no-platforming, n.
- onshoring, n.
- overnight oats, n.

mountweazel

NOUN

QUOTATIONS

Hide all quotations

CONTENTS

An invented or fake entry in a reference work (esp. a...

An invented or fake entry in a reference work (esp. a dictionary or an encyclopedia), a database, etc., typically used by the publisher to identify plagiarism that constitutes an infringement of copyright. **2005–**

2005 An independent investigator set himself the task of sifting through NOAD's [= New Oxford American Dictionary] thirty-one hundred and twenty-eight 'e' entries in search of the phony... Six potential Mountweazels emerged.

New Yorker 29 August 32/2 ...

2009 Such an intentional mistake—known as a Mountweazel or Nihilartikel—effectively poisons the database to unlicensed users, because its presence proves that the data was copied rather than created from scratch.

Guardian 24 September (Technology Guardian section) 2/3 ...

Neologisms: How Do We Get New Words?





Reduplication



Onomatopoeia



Eponyms



Abbreviations



Back-formation



Clipping



Blending



De novo



Compounding



Conversion

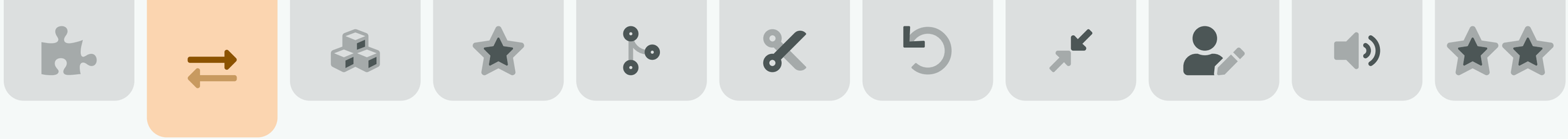


Affixation

Affixation

English affixes are used to create a **non-transparent** new word.

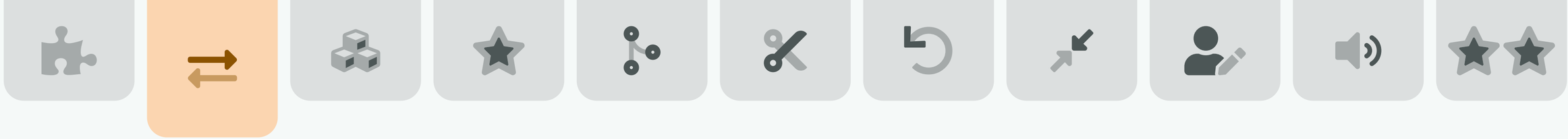
- *graceful/disgraceful*
- *spectacle/spectacles*
- *new/news*
- *hard/hardly*



Conversion

Take a word form from another part of speech.


I LIKE TO VERB WORDS.
WHAT?
I TAKE NOUNS AND ADJECTIVES AND USE THEM AS VERBS. REMEMBER WHEN "ACCESS" WAS A THING? NOW IT'S SOMETHING YOU DO. IT GOT VERBED.
VERBING WEIRDS LANGUAGE.
MAYBE WE CAN EVENTUALLY MAKE LANGUAGE A COMPLETE IMPEDIMENT TO UNDERSTANDING.



Conversion

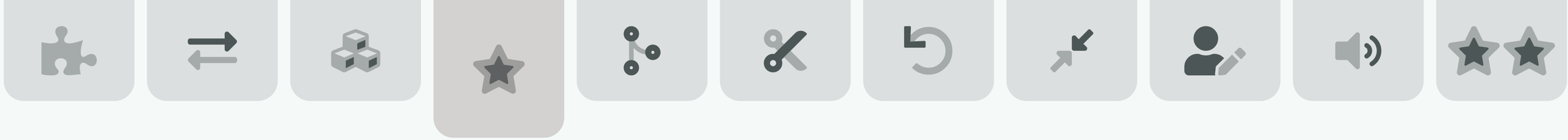
Take a word form from another part of speech.

- *access*
- *email*
- *fish*
- *smooth*
- *gaatekeep*
- *convict*
- *present*
- *refuse*
- *torment*
- *record, rebel*

Compounding

English **bases** are compounded together.

hovercraft	*hover + craft*
bonfire	*bone + fire*
holiday	*holy + day*
woman	*wife + man*
goodbye	*god + be + with + ye*
lord	*loaf + ward*
hussy	*house + wife*



De novo

Entirely new word invented by putting together letters/sounds.

- *flabbergast*
- *gizmo*
- *Muppet*
- *Kodak*
- *Quark*
- *Jedi*
- *Viagra*
- *Prozac*
- *Nylon*

Blending (*portmanteau*)

Taking parts of two words and merging them

brunch	*breakfast + lunch*
sitcom	*situation + comedy*
romantasy	*romance + fantasy*
blog	*web + log*
examnesia	*exam + amnesia*
tradwife	*traditional + wife*



Clipping

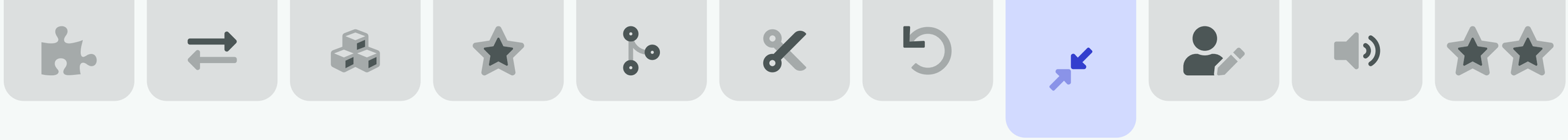
A shortened form of a word becomes a word in its own right.

flu	*influenza*
hyper	*hyperactive*
copter	*helicopter*
sci-fi	*science fiction*
gin	*Geneva/engine*
rizz	*charisma*

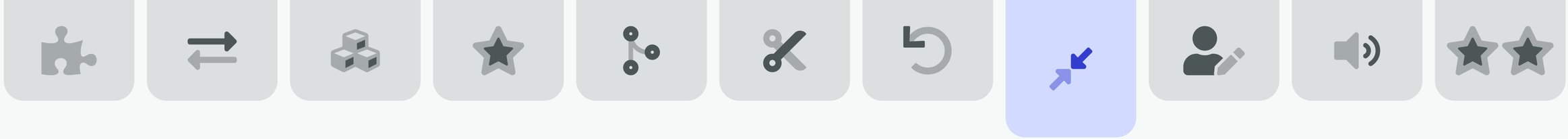
Back-formation

Creation of words by (mistaken) analogy.

- *to burgle*
- *to buttle*
- *cherry*
- *grovel*



Abbreviation

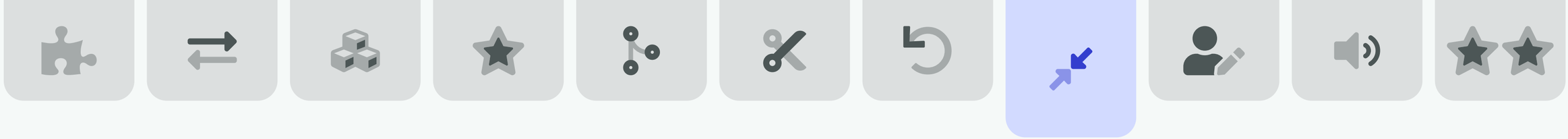


Abbrev.

Taking the first letters, the first sounds, or the first few letters of words and combining them into a new word.

ACRONYMS

- *Nasa*
- *Shape*
- *Nato*
- *Laser*
- *Radar*
- *Modem*
- *Jeep*
- *Potus/Scotus*
- *Fubar/Snafu*
- *Lol (LOL?)*

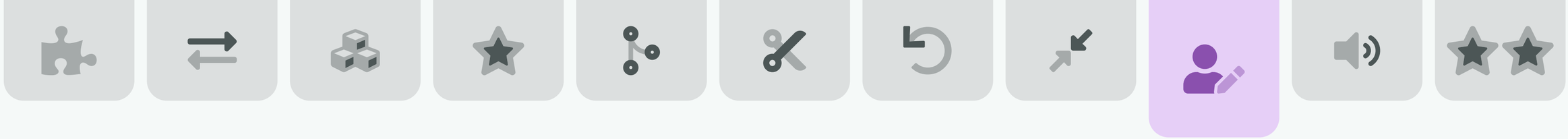


Abbrev.

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INITIALISMS

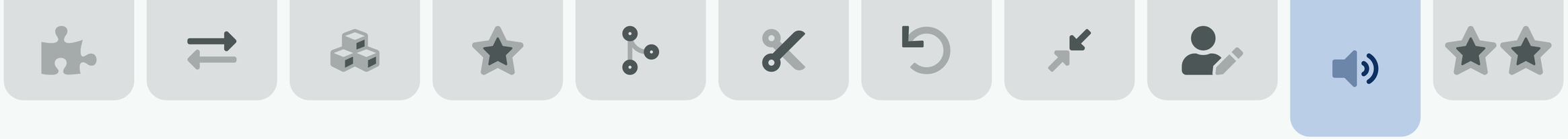
- *FDR*
- *BBC*
- *UK*
- *AM/PM*
- *BC/AD*
- *CE/BCE*
- *MA/PhD*
- *LOL (Lol?)*
- *FAQ (Faq?)*
- *LLM*



Eponyms

Words from names.

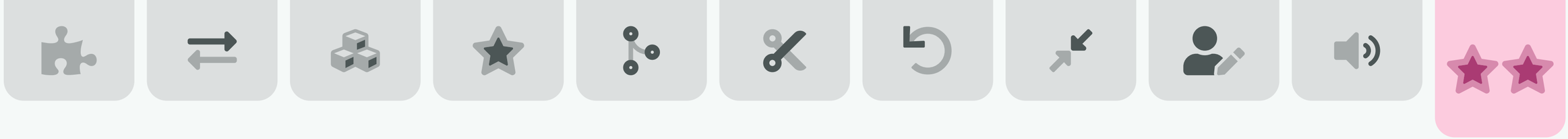
- *watt*
- *kelvin*
- *boycott*
- *cardigan*
- *lynch*
- *nicotine*
- *cheddar*
- *denim*
- *port*
- *sherry*
- *atlas*
- *morphine/morph*
- *panic*
- *to Instagram*



Onomatopoeia

Emulating a sound in a word.

- *woof*
- *baa / bleat*
- *quack*
- *roar*
- *burble*
- *meow*
- *bang*
- *cuckoo*



Reduplication

When part or all of a word is repeated.

- *hip-hop*
- *bonbon*
- *ping-pong*
- *itty-bitty*
- *mish-mash*
- *fifty-fifty*



ENGLISH WORDS

History, Meaning, and Structure

University of Glasgow

Neologisms: New and Improved

Marc Alexander

English Language & Linguistics 2A, Week 5